

STUDY NOTES · UPSSSC PET 2026

General English — Sentence Ability

UPSSSC PET 2026 Detailed Notes · Spotting Errors, Improvement & Fillers

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General English

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General English — Sentence Ability

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Focus: Sentence Correction → Sentence Improvement → Fill in the Blanks → Error Detection → Sentence Arrangement

Hindi Help: Only for difficult grammar logic or confusing exam patterns.

1. What is Sentence Ability?

Sentence ability means understanding whether a sentence is **grammatically correct, logically complete, properly ordered, and appropriate in context**.

For PET, sentence ability is built from grammar, vocabulary, collocation, context, and logical sequencing.

💡 Exam Tip

Exam Tip: Never change a sentence simply because it sounds unusual. Identify the exact grammar, usage, or logic rule first.

2. Sentence Structure Basics

A basic sentence can be represented as:

Subject + Verb + Object / Complement

Ravi reads books.

- **Subject:** the person/thing about which the sentence is made.
- **Verb:** action, occurrence, or state.
- **Object:** receives the action.
- **Complement:** completes the meaning of the subject/object.

2.1 Phrase vs Clause

Phrase: a group of words functioning as a unit, normally without a finite verb.

in the morning

Clause: a group of words containing a subject-verb relationship.

when he arrived

2.2 Sentence Types by Structure

Simple Sentence

One independent clause.

She works hard.

Compound Sentence

Two or more independent clauses joined appropriately.

She works hard, and she studies regularly.

Complex Sentence

One independent clause and one or more subordinate clauses.

She studies hard because she wants to succeed.

Core Concept

Sentence structure is the foundation of **correction, improvement, error detection, and arrangement** questions.

3. Sentence Correction

Sentence correction asks you to identify an incorrect form and replace it with the grammatically or contextually correct form.

3.1 Correction Checklist

Check in this order:

1. Subject-Verb Agreement
2. Tense and verb form
3. Pronoun
4. Article / Determiner
5. Preposition
6. Adjective / Adverb
7. Conjunction
8. Word order
9. Parallel structure
10. Meaning and logical fit
11. Collocation / idiomatic usage

∴ strategy **Locate** → **Identify the rule** → **Correct** → **Re-read the complete sentence.**

Change only what is necessary. ∴

4. Subject-Verb Errors

A singular subject generally takes a singular verb in the present simple; a plural subject generally takes a plural verb.

- ⊗ He **go** to school.
- ⊙ He **goes** to school.
- ⊗ The students **is** ready.
- ⊙ The students **are** ready.

Intervening Phrases

- ⊗ The quality of these products **are** good.
- ✓ The quality of these products **is** good.

The subject is **quality**, not products.

⚠ Trap

Do not select the verb according to the nearest noun. Find the grammatical subject first.

5. Tense and Verb-Form Errors

After Do / Does / Did

Use V1.

- ⊗ Did he **went** there?
- ✓ Did he **go** there?
- ⊗ She does not **likes** tea.
- ✓ She does not **like** tea.

After Modals

Use V1.

- ⊗ He can **swims**.
- ✓ He can **swim**.

Perfect Forms

Use **have/has/had + V3**.

- ⊗ She has **went** home.
- ✓ She has **gone** home.

 Remember

did + V1

modal + V1

have/has/had + V3

6. Pronoun Errors

A pronoun should clearly and appropriately refer to its antecedent.

⊗ Riya told Priya that **she** had won.

This may be ambiguous without context.

Pronoun Case

After a preposition, use the appropriate object form in formal standard usage:

⊗ Between you and **I**

✓ Between you and **me**

 Exam Tip

Always identify the antecedent before selecting a pronoun.

7. Article and Determiner Errors

A / An

Choose according to sound.

⊗ an university

✓ a university

⊗ a hour

✓ an hour

Much / Many

- **many** + countable plural noun
- **much** + uncountable noun

⊗ much students

✓ many students

Few / A Few / Little / A Little

- few → almost none; countable plural
- a few → some; countable plural
- little → almost none; uncountable
- a little → some; uncountable

⚠ Trap

The article can change the meaning: **few** and **a few** are not equivalent.

8. Preposition Errors

Common combinations:

- good **at** English
- interested **in** music
- depend **on** someone
- consist **of** parts
- listen **to** music
- responsible **for** the work
- afraid **of** dogs
- different **from** another

⊗ He discussed **about** the issue.

✓ He discussed the issue.

⚠ Warning

Learn prepositions with the word they normally accompany. Direct translation from Hindi often creates errors.

9. Adjective and Adverb Errors

Adjective: modifies a noun/pronoun.

She is a **careful** driver.

Adverb: modifies a verb, adjective, adverb, or clause.

She drives **carefully**.

After linking verbs such as **be, seem, look, feel, become**, an adjective is often used to describe the subject.

She looks **beautiful**.

⚠ Trap

Do not automatically add **-ly** to make an adverb. Word function and meaning matter.

10. Comparison Errors

Comparative

Ravi is **taller than** Mohan.

Superlative

Ravi is **the tallest** boy in the class.

Avoid double comparison:

- ⊗ more better
- ⊗ most tallest
- ✓ better
- ✓ tallest

Common irregular forms:

- good → better → best
- bad → worse → worst
- little → less → least
- many/much → more → most

11. Conjunction Errors

Common correlative pairs:

- either...or
- neither...nor
- both...and
- not only...but also
- whether...or

She is **not only intelligent but also hardworking**.

⚠ Warning

Maintain parallel grammatical structures after paired conjunctions.

12. Parallelism

Parallelism means using the same grammatical form for items in a series or comparison.

- ⊗ She likes **reading, to write, and dancing**.
- ✓ She likes **reading, writing, and dancing**.

Other examples:

⊗ He wanted to **study, working, and to travel**.

✓ He wanted to **study, work, and travel**.

Core Concept

When several items are joined by **and/or**, check whether they perform the same grammatical role.

13. Modifiers and Word Order

A modifier should be positioned so that its intended meaning is clear.

Basic Word Order

Subject → Verb → Object

The student solved the problem.

Misplaced Modifier

She almost finished all the work.

The position of **almost** affects what is being limited.

💡 Exam Tip

English generally depends more strongly on word order than Hindi. Avoid direct word-for-word translation.

14. Sentence Improvement

Sentence improvement questions present a sentence with an underlined or highlighted part. You must select the option that gives the **best grammatical and contextual form**.

14.1 Improvement Strategy

1. Read the complete sentence.
2. Identify the faulty portion.
3. Determine the rule involved.
4. Check whether the original may already be correct.
5. Compare the alternatives.
6. Choose the most natural and precise form.

∴ strategy **Do not improve only grammar**. Check grammar + meaning + tense + collocation + logical consistency. ∴

14.2 Common Improvement Areas

- subject-verb agreement
- tense
- articles
- prepositions
- pronouns
- comparison
- parallelism
- word choice
- collocation
- redundancy

Examples

1. He is senior **than** me.
→ He is senior **to** me.
2. She returned **back** home.
→ She returned home.
3. He discussed **about** the issue.
→ He discussed the issue.
4. She is **more better** than her sister.
→ She is better than her sister.

Warning

Some improvement questions contain an option such as **"No improvement"**. Do not change a correct sentence unnecessarily.

15. Redundancy

Redundancy occurs when unnecessary words repeat the same meaning.

Common examples:

- return back → return
- repeat again → repeat
- discuss about → discuss
- enter into the room → enter the room (when "enter" means go into)
- revert back → revert

Trap

Not every repeated-looking phrase is automatically wrong; judge the actual construction and meaning.

16. Fill in the Blanks

Fill-in-the-blank questions can test grammar, vocabulary, collocation, and context.

Step-by-Step Method

1. Read the entire sentence.
2. Predict the required part of speech.
3. Check grammar.
4. Check meaning.
5. Check collocation.
6. Insert the best option.
7. Re-read the full sentence.

Grammar Clues

He is ___ honest man. → **an**

She is good ___ English. → **at**

Everyone ___ ready. → **is**

She has ___ the work. → **completed**

Context Clue

The instructions were very ___, so everyone understood them.

The answer should express **clarity**, not simply fit grammatically.

17. Cloze-Style Context Fillers

A cloze passage contains several blanks. Each blank must be solved using the **local grammar and the overall meaning of the passage**.

Cloze Strategy

1. Read the complete passage once.
2. Identify the topic and tone.
3. Predict the missing word.
4. Check grammar around the blank.
5. Check the meaning of the whole sentence.
6. Re-read the passage after filling all blanks.

∴ strategy Do not solve every cloze blank independently. Later sentences can provide clues for earlier blanks. ∴

18. Collocations

A collocation is a combination of words that commonly occur together.

Examples:

- **make** a decision
- **do** homework
- **take** a break
- **pay** attention
- **catch** a bus
- **heavy** rain
- **strong** tea
- **deep** sleep
- **commit** a crime
- **keep** a promise

⚠ Warning

A grammatically possible word is not always the natural word. Collocation can determine the correct answer.

19. Error Detection

In error-detection questions, a sentence may be divided into parts.

He / do / his work / regularly.

Error → **do**

Correction → **does**

Error Detection Order

Subject-Verb → Tense → Pronoun → Article/Determiner → Preposition → Modifier → Parallelism → Vocabulary/Collocation

⚡ Trick

For a long sentence, first locate the **main subject + main verb + object/complement**. Then inspect the likely error zones.

20. Mixed Grammar Errors

A sentence may contain more than one possible-looking problem. Identify the error that actually violates standard grammar or the intended meaning.

Example:

The students of this class **is** preparing for the test.

Main error → **is**

Correction → **are**

The phrase **of this class** does not change the plural subject **students**.

21. Sentence Arrangement

Sentence arrangement requires you to put sentences or parts into a logical sequence.

21.1 Opening Sentence

A likely opening sentence often:

- introduces the topic
- introduces the person/thing
- gives the general background
- does not depend on an earlier reference

A sentence beginning with **he, she, this, that, these, such, therefore** is often unlikely to be the first sentence if its reference has not yet been introduced.

21.2 Pronoun Link

Ravi entered the room. **He** sat down.

The sentence introducing Ravi normally precedes the sentence beginning with **he**.

21.3 Demonstrative Link

Words such as **this, that, these, those, such** often refer to an earlier idea or noun.

21.4 Connector Link

- however → contrast
- therefore → result
- moreover → addition
- consequently → result
- finally → concluding stage

⚡ Trick

Look for **mandatory pairs** before trying every possible order. If one sentence clearly explains “this”, find the sentence that introduces the relevant idea.

22. Chronological Order

When events occur over time, use the sequence:

first → then → next → after that → finally

Other clues include dates, ages, stages, and time expressions.

23. Cause and Effect

Common pattern:

Cause → Result

It rained heavily. **Therefore**, the match was cancelled.

Result markers

therefore, hence, thus, consequently, as a result

Cause markers

because, since, as, due to, owing to

💡 Exam Tip

A result marker normally connects an effect to an earlier cause or explanation.

24. Contrast and Continuation

Contrast

however, but, although, nevertheless, whereas, yet

Addition

moreover, furthermore, also, in addition, besides

⚠️ Trap

However normally signals a contrast with a preceding idea. Do not automatically make it the first sentence of a paragraph.

25. Advanced Sentence Arrangement Technique

Use a **link-chain** approach:

Opening → Noun introduction → Pronoun/reference → Explanation → Result/example → Conclusion

Strong clues

1. Full name → pronoun
2. General statement → specific example
3. Cause → effect
4. Question → answer/explanation
5. Problem → solution
6. First event → later event
7. Claim → evidence

∴ strategy If options are given as sequences, find a strong pair first. Once one pair is fixed, eliminate sequences that break that pair. ∴

26. Question Formation

Correct question structure is useful in sentence correction and transformation.

Yes/No Questions

Auxiliary + Subject + Main Verb...?

Does he work here?

WH Questions

WH-word + Auxiliary + Subject + Main Verb...?

Where does he live?

⚠ Trap

After an auxiliary such as **do/does/did**, use V1:

- ⊗ Where did he went?
- ✓ Where did he go?

27. Negative Sentence Formation

Common patterns:

- Present simple → do/does not + V1
- Past simple → did not + V1
- Be verb → be + not
- Modal → modal + not + V1
- Perfect → have/has/had + not + V3

Examples:

He does not work here.

She did not go.

He cannot swim.

They have not finished.

28. Punctuation Basics for Sentence Ability

Basic punctuation can affect sentence clarity.

Full Stop

Ends a statement.

Comma

Separates items, introductory elements, or clauses in appropriate constructions.

Apostrophe

Shows possession or contraction.

- Ravi's book
- don't = do not

Question Mark

Used after a direct question.

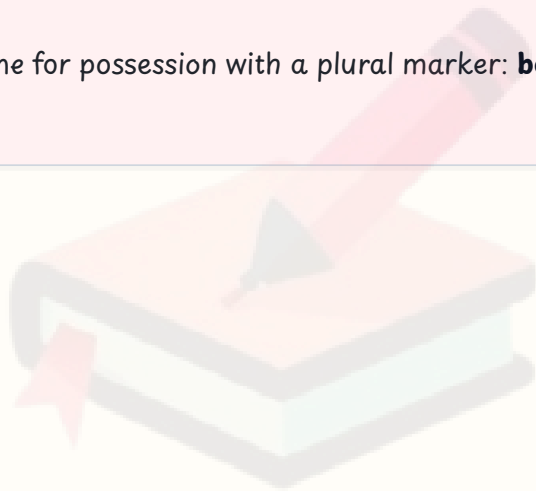
Where are you going?

Quotation Marks

Used for direct speech in standard English writing.

⚠ Warning

Do not confuse an apostrophe for possession with a plural marker: **book's** does not normally mean "books".



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29. Common Sentence Ability Traps

Trap

Trap 1 — Nearest noun

The nearest noun is not necessarily the subject.

Trap 2 — Direct translation

Hindi sentence order does not always map directly to English.

Trap 3 — Familiar option

A familiar word may still be grammatically or contextually wrong.

Trap 4 — Connector without reference

However, therefore, this, that, and such often depend on earlier context.

Trap 5 — Pronoun before antecedent

A pronoun may be unclear when its reference has not been established.

Trap 6 — Double comparison

more better / most tallest.

Trap 7 — Redundancy

return back / repeat again / discuss about.

Trap 8 — Collocation

A word can be grammatically possible but unnatural with the surrounding words.

Trap 9 — No improvement

Do not alter a sentence merely to make it different.

30. Quick Correction Bank

Incorrect	Correct	Rule
He do his work.	He does his work.	agreement
Did she went?	Did she go?	did + V1
He can sings.	He can sing.	modal + V1
She has went home.	She has gone home.	perfect + V3
an university	a university	sound
a hour	an hour	sound
much students	many students	countability
He discussed about it.	He discussed it.	discuss + object
Between you and I	Between you and me	object form
more better	better	comparison
most tallest	tallest	comparison
reading, to write, dancing	reading, writing, dancing	parallelism
He is senior than me.	He is senior to me.	usage
return back	return	redundancy
repeat again	repeat	redundancy

31. Hindi Help — Fast Identification

Task	Ask yourself
Subject	Who/what controls the verb?
Object	Who/what receives the action?
Tense	When/how is the action expressed?
Article	General or specific? What sound follows?
Preposition	Which fixed combination is required?
Improvement	Is the alternative grammatically and contextually better?
Error	Which exact rule is broken?
Arrangement	Which sentence introduces and which sentence refers?
Connector	Cause, result, contrast, or addition?

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32. Practice Set — Sentence Ability

Practice

Section A — Correction

1. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. He do his work daily.
- B. He does his work daily.
- C. He doing his work daily.
- D. He did his work daily every day.

2. Did she ___ the letter?

- A. wrote B. writes C. write D. writing

3. Everyone ___ present.

- A. are B. were C. is D. have

4. He is good ___ English.

- A. in B. at C. on D. by

5. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. She is more better than me.
- B. She is better than me.
- C. She is most better than me.
- D. She is very better than me.

6. Choose the correct article: He is ___ honest man.

- A. a B. an C. the D. no article

7. Choose the correct form: She has ___ home.

- A. went B. go C. gone D. going

8. Choose the parallel sentence.

- A. She likes reading, to write and dancing.
- B. She likes reading, writing and dancing.
- C. She likes to reading, writing and dance.
- D. She likes read, writing and dancing.

9. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. He discussed about the problem.
- B. He discussed the problem.

C. He discussed on the problem.

D. He discussed for the problem.

10. The quality of these products ___ good.

A. are B. were C. is D. have

Section B — Sentence Improvement

11. He is senior ___ me.

A. than B. to C. from D. with

12. She returned ___ home.

A. back B. again C. to back D. no additional word

13. Choose the best form: He discussed ___ the issue.

A. about B. on C. for D. no preposition

14. Choose the best sentence.

A. She is more better now.

B. She is better now.

C. She is most better now.

D. She is very better now.

15. Choose the correct form: He wanted to study, ___, and travel.

A. working B. worked C. work D. to working

Section C — Fill in the Blanks

16. She has lived here ___ 2020.

A. for B. since C. during D. by

17. There are ___ students in the room.

A. much B. many C. little D. a little

18. The instructions were very ___, so everyone understood them.

A. clear B. careless C. hostile D. reluctant

19. He ___ a decision after careful thought.

A. did B. made C. paid D. took up

20. She is ___ honest person.

A. a B. an C. the D. no article

Section D — Arrangement

21. Arrange the sentences:

- A. He opened the book.
- B. Ravi sat at his desk.
- C. He began to read.

- A. A-B-C
- B. B-A-C
- C. C-A-B
- D. B-C-A

22. Which is usually the best opening sentence?

- A. This surprised everyone.
- B. He then entered the room.
- C. Ravi entered the room.
- D. Therefore, they left.

23. Which connector normally signals a result?

- A. However
- B. Although
- C. Therefore
- D. But

24. Which connector most clearly signals contrast?

- A. therefore
- B. however
- C. consequently
- D. hence

25. In an arrangement, which usually comes first?

- A. He, when the person has not been introduced
- B. This, when the idea has not been introduced
- C. The sentence introducing the main topic
- D. Therefore, without a previous cause

Section E — Mixed Ability

26. Choose the correct question.

- A. Where did he went?
- B. Where did he go?
- C. Where he did go?
- D. Where did he going?

27. Choose the correct negative sentence.

- A. She did not went.
- B. She did not goes.
- C. She did not go.
- D. She not did go.

28. Identify the error: "The quality of these products are excellent."

- A. quality
- B. these
- C. are
- D. excellent

29. Choose the correct collocation.

- A. do a decision
- B. make a decision
- C. pay a decision
- D. give a decision

30. Choose the correct indirect-question form.

- A. He asked where was I going.
- B. He asked where I was going.
- C. He asked where am I going.
- D. He asked where going I was.

31. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. Between you and I, this is true.
- B. Between you and me, this is true.
- C. Between you and myself, this is true.
- D. Between you and mine, this is true.

32. Choose the correct article.

- A. a hour
- B. an hour
- C. the hour always
- D. an university

33. Choose the correct sentence.



- A. She looks beautifully.
- B. She looks beautiful.
- C. She looks beauty.
- D. She looks beautify.

34. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. He can swims well.
- B. He can swim well.
- C. He can swimming well.
- D. He can swam well.

35. Choose the best correction: "He returned back yesterday."

- A. He returned yesterday.
- B. He returned back again yesterday.
- C. He did returned yesterday.
- D. He returning yesterday.

36. Choose the sentence with correct parallelism.

- A. She likes reading, to write and dancing.
- B. She likes reading, writing and dancing.
- C. She likes read, writing and dance.
- D. She likes to reading, writing and dancing.

37. Choose the best connector: "It was raining heavily; ____, the match was cancelled."

- A. however
- B. therefore
- C. although
- D. meanwhile

38. Choose the correct form: "Everyone ____ their work."

- A. have completed
- B. has completed
- C. are completing
- D. were complete

39. Which sentence is most likely to be the opening sentence of an arrangement?

- A. This was unexpected.
- B. Therefore, the plan failed.
- C. The committee announced a new plan.
- D. He then explained it.

40. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. She has seen him yesterday.
- B. She saw him yesterday.
- C. She had saw him yesterday.
- D. She has seeing him yesterday.

41. Choose the correct word: "He is interested ___ science."

- A. on B. at C. in D. for

42. Choose the correct word: "The students ___ ready."

- A. is B. are C. was D. has

43. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. He asked where was she going.
- B. He asked where she was going.
- C. He asked where is she going.
- D. He asked where going she was.

44. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. Repeat again the answer.
- B. Repeat the answer.
- C. Repeat back again the answer.
- D. Repeated again the answer.

45. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. He discussed about the matter.
- B. He discussed the matter.
- C. He discussed on the matter.
- D. He discussed for the matter.

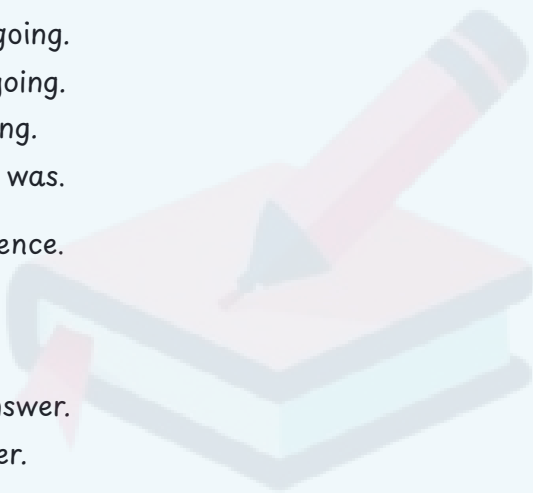
46. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. She is good in English.
- B. She is good at English.
- C. She is good on English.
- D. She is good by English.

47. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. Neither the teacher nor the students is ready.
- B. Neither the teacher nor the students are ready.
- C. Neither the teacher or the students are ready.
- D. Neither teacher nor students is ready always.

48. Choose the correct sentence.



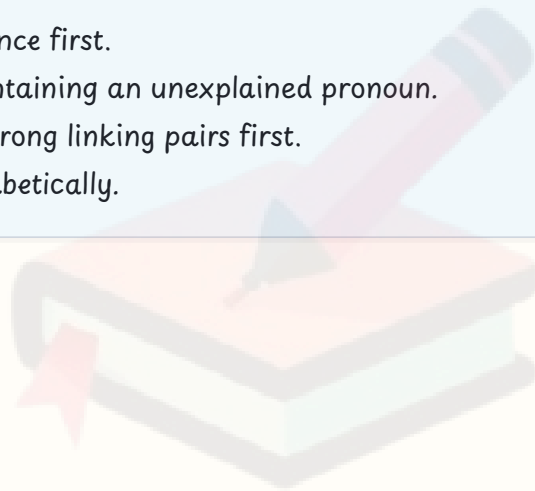
- A. I have been waiting for two hours.
- B. I have been waiting since two hours.
- C. I am waiting since two hours.
- D. I waited since two hours.

49. Choose the correct sentence.

- A. He entered into the room.
- B. He entered the room.
- C. He entered in the room.
- D. He did entered the room.

50. Choose the best strategy for a difficult sentence-arrangement question.

- A. Choose the longest sentence first.
- B. Start with a sentence containing an unexplained pronoun.
- C. Find opening clues and strong linking pairs first.
- D. Arrange sentences alphabetically.



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33. Answer Key

Q	Ans	Key Point
1	B	agreement
2	C	did + V1
3	C	everyone → singular
4	B	good at
5	B	no double comparison
6	B	vowel sound
7	C	perfect + V3
8	B	parallelism
9	B	discuss + object
10	C	subject = quality
11	B	senior to
12	D	return already includes the idea
13	D	discuss + object
14	B	better
15	C	parallel V1 forms
16	B	since + starting point
17	B	many + countable plural
18	A	context
19	B	make a decision
20	B	vowel sound
21	B	introduction → action → result

Q	Ans	Key Point
22	C	topic introduction
23	C	result
24	B	contrast
25	C	opening sentence
26	B	did + V1
27	C	did not + V1
28	C	subject = quality
29	B	collocation
30	B	statement word order
31	B	object form
32	B	vowel sound
33	B	linking verb + adjective
34	B	modal + V1
35	A	remove redundancy
36	B	parallelism
37	B	result
38	B	everyone + singular verb
39	C	topic introduction
40	B	finished past time
41	C	interested in
42	B	plural subject
43	B	indirect-question word order
44	B	remove redundancy
45	B	discuss + object

Q	Ans	Key Point
46	B	good at
47	B	nearest subject in common exam construction
48	A	for + duration
49	B	enter + object
50	C	strong-link method

Remember

Sentence Ability Formula:

Grammar + Meaning + Context + Collocation + Logical Order = Correct Sentence

For PET, first master the rule, then apply it to correction, improvement, fillers, error detection, and arrangement questions.

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